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Skullcaps and turbans

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5.) Afqir: Usually between the ages of 40 and 45, most men undergo a noticeable change in comportment. They begin to shave their heads, to grow beards, and to exchange the skullcap they have worn since the age of about six for a turban. Today, they also often cease to wear Western-style trousers and shoes, in favor of Moroccan serwal and babouches (iduk ° an). Their manner of speaking becomes more dignified  141 and restrained, and they gradually cease using young mens' slang and worldly joking. They begin to pay much stricter attention to the acquittal of their religious obligations, including daily prayers and attendance at the Friday services in the village mosque. From this point onward, increasing numbers of them will "take up the rosary", that is, become adherents of one of the three religious brotherhoods active in Idaw Tanan, membership in which imposes a strict discipline in daily conduct. Significantly, in Ta[unknown]selh[unknown]it, the word for "mature man" and the word for "adherent of a religious brotherhood" are identical: afqir (although the two senses have different plurals: ifqiren and fuqarâ' respectively).

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